

First Stage Interview Process

Estimated time needed: 4 minutes

Introduction

Many organizations interview potential employment candidates in multiple stages. While the first level of shortlisting happens with the HR screening process, the first stage of the interview is a way to narrow down the list of candidates further.

As a potential candidate, you should use the first stage of the interview as an opportunity to make a great first impression and qualify for the next interview stages. Make sure to be prepared!

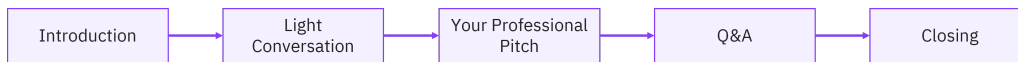
Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to:

- Describe the steps in the first stage interview process
- Apply tips to succeed in the first stage interview

First stage interview process: Steps

The first stage interview normally follows a standard process. Let's review the steps.



1. Introduction

The interviewer will introduce themselves and greet you with a handshake. This is your opportunity to introduce yourself as well.

2. Light Conversation

The interviewer will try to make a personal connection with you. In addition, this light conversation allows the interviewer to view and initially assess your interpersonal and communication skills. Make eye contact, smile, and speak clearly and concisely.

3. Your Professional Pitch

You will have an opportunity to provide a brief summary of your personal experience and professional background. Take time to research the company you are interviewing for and understand the job description for the position you seek. Websites and social media channels are great choices. Try to match your experience and skills to the job and the needs of the organization. In addition, be ready to respond to questions about your skills and share your interest in the position you are interviewing for.

4. Question and Answer

The interviewer will ask you general questions during this phase. In addition, you will be given an opportunity to ask questions as well. You will be provided with a list of questions you can expect in a first stage interview and questions you may want to consider asking later in this lesson. Take time to listen to each question before you respond. A short pause to gather your thoughts is fine. Answer the question that was asked and avoid tangents.

5. Closing

The interviewer will let you know when the interview is complete. This is where the next steps can be discussed.

Tips for success

- Plan ahead and arrive early for the interview. Try to arrive 10 or 15 minutes before the interview begins. This allows you to acclimate to the environment and shows respect for the interviewer's time.
- Bring at least five copies of your resume. You may have multiple interviewers. Have copies available to hand out to them.

Note: There may be times when the first stage interview is virtual. If this is the case, provide copies of all documents you wish to share using the application. In addition, know how to share documents if required.

- Pass out business cards to each interviewer if you have them with your resume. In addition, try to obtain a business card from each interviewer.
- Bring a pen and notebook. Write down key talking points mentioned in the interview. Be ready to refer back to these points after the interview.
- Have a list of references and short testimonials available to share if required. References can be both professional and personal. Professional references can share how you did on the job. Personal references can speak to your character.
- Follow up after the interview and send a personalized thank you note to each person you interviewed with. Email then within 24 to 48 hours after the interview. Refer to the notes you took and the business cards you obtained.

Refer to the reading, [The Remote or Virtual Meeting](#), for tips on preparing for a virtual interview.



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